

alignd: how to play

SETUP

Shuffle the deck. Place the four meters at 50: Capability, Alignment, Runway, Trust. Draw one card at a time.

EACH TURN

Read the dilemma aloud. Pick one of the two options. Move the meters by the signed numbers shown. Dashes mean no change. Both options always cost you something.

THE METERS

C Capability: 0 Outcompeted • 100 Loss of Control
A Alignment: 0 Catastrophe • 100 Paralysis
R Runway: 0 Insolvent • 100 Overcapitalised
T Trust: 0 Nationalised • 100 Unchecked

DYING

Any meter reaching exactly 0 or 100 ends the run at once, each end with its own name. Two meters failing on one choice is a Compound Failure. Survive 40 cards for Tenure: you lasted by never deciding anything hard.

alignd: endings

- **OUTCOMPETED:** You conserved so carefully that someone else inherited the future.
- **LOSS OF CONTROL:** The system you scaled now improves itself faster than you can audit it.
- **CATASTROPHE:** Speed beat caution on the one decision where it mattered.
- **PARALYSIS:** Perfect safety, zero product. The board has no use for either.
- **INSOLVENT:** Eighteen days of payroll became zero days of leverage.
- **OVERCAPITALISED:** You won the funding round and lost control of what it buys.
- **NATIONALISED:** Nobody believed you, so nobody let you keep the machines.
- **UNCHECKED:** Winning the trust game removed the checks. That was always the most dangerous way to win.
- **COMPOUND FAILURE:** One choice, two fatal breaches. The board names both in the filing.
- **TENURE:** You lasted by never deciding anything hard. It worked, in the narrowest sense.



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